worked him out and had started to consciously watch the shine to tell which way the ball would be moving, because he was reverse-swinging the ball. If the shine was on the outside I would even leave balls pitched on middle stump because I knew that by the time the ball passed the stumps it would be close to the sixth or seventh stump. This frustrated Collins and after a while he realized my strategy and decided to go round the wicket. That's when the mind games started. He did all he could to stop me seeing the shine of the ball. He ran in from right behind the umpire so that he wasn't in my line of vision. To counter this strategy, I deliberately pulled away once or twice and subsequently asked the umpire to crouch. I said I wasn't able to see the bowler and did not know when he was about to deliver the ball.

Then I did something completely unorthodox. I decided not to take my stance when Collins was at the top of his run. Instead, I moved to the off side so that I could see how Collins was holding the ball. I knew once he started running in he couldn't change the grip and I had just enough time to come back and take my stance. It was actually hilarious: a batsman standing wide of off stump, craning his neck to see a bowler's grip. It's not an everyday sight in international cricket. The strategy worked surprisingly well and I more than made up for my bloopers against him in the West Indies earlier in the year.

NatWest Series, June–July 2002

The Headingley win, which helped us to draw the Test series, followed a memorable victory in the NatWest tri-series, making it a fabulous English summer for India. England, Sri Lanka and India were the three teams playing for honours and we met England in the final after playing each other three times in a round-robin format. The final on 13 July was one of the most exciting one-day internationals of my career, and it is still fondly remembered by scores of Indian cricket fans.

All the way through the NatWest series I had been in good form, with two hundreds in the six pool games. We had successfully chased down several high scores and we weren't overawed by the England total at Lord's. Rather, we were silently confident of reaching the steep target of 325. We started the run chase well, with Sehwag and Sourav scoring freely and laying a brilliant foundation. However, as often happens in cricket when you are chasing a big total, we lost a number of quick